



*For the students, teachers, librarians,
and faculty of the schools in Rochester,
Michigan, and for everyone involved in the
Authors in April program. Thank you.
This book wouldn't be the same without you.
—J. F.*

*To Jamey and my four dogs:
Samurai, Hansel, Gretel, and Jinx
—E. T.*

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LITTLE RED RIDING HOOD

by Josh Funk
Illustrated by Edwardian Taylor

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Once upon a time, Little Red Riding Hood lived with her family in a cottage on the outskirts of the woods.



Everyone loved Little Red, especially her grandmother. Little Red's grandma loved her so much that she sent her a red cape with a hood she had sewed just for her.

That's why they call me **LITTLE RED CAPE 'N' HOOD**.



No, they call you Little Red Riding Hood.

Little Red began the journey to—

Little Red! You're supposed to
be on your way to Grandma's house!

SWEET JELLY!
I completely
forgot. I'll leave
right now!

But you
said we'd play
ROLLING STONES
with the
BETLES.

Sorry, Sis. We
can toss rocks
down **INSECT HILL**
another time.



Hurry up! Your sick grandma needs you!

Right! Hey,
Little Blue—I'm
borrowing your
cape 'n' hood,
okay?

What?! You can't wear blue!
You're Little **RED!**

Don't be silly. I
don't have to wear
red just because my
name is Red.

Look at my
mother. Her name
isn't **FRILLY APRON**
PURPLE SOCKS!



Yeah,
her name is
JENNIFER Purple
Socks.



Fine. Wear blue. Just get going to Grandma's.

Who are YOU?

I be the
Big Bad Wolf,
of course!

You're not a wolf.

But look
what big,
sharp teeth
I have!

You're
not fooling
anyone,
mister.

Aye, ya got me.
I'm Captain Hook.
The Big Bad Wolf
called in sick,
so I be fillin' in.



WHAT? The Big Bad Wolf can't be sick.

My grandma's
sick. Something
must be going
around.

Look, I'm
doin' the wolf
a favor. Villains
can be nice
sometimes
too.

What exactly
do you mean by
villain?

Umm ...
let's just move on!





Am I too early?

Who are YOU?

I'm the woodsman! I'm here to rescue Little Red and Grandma!

Woodsman, what a big nose you have!

Okay! That was a lie. I'm Pinocchio.

Let me guess. The woodsman called in sick?

YES! And now I must battle the fake grandma!

Stop battling! There's no battling in this story!

Umm, they're clearly battling.

Oh, hi, Grandma.

So just to recap,
you wanted to tell
a story about a girl
who takes a walk in
the woods and
gets eaten by
a wolf?

EXACTLY!

But instead,
the story featured
a pirate, a puppet,
a fierce battle, a healthy grandma,
delicious ice cream, nobody
dying . . . and you're
upset about this?



Well . . . when you put
it like that . . . it doesn't
sound so bad.

Trust me,
this story got a
lot better when
the ice cream
arrived.



WELCOME
TO GRANDMA'S
ICE CREAM
SHOPPE!

I guess you'll all
live happily ever
after now.

Who knows?
I'm just a kid.
I hope to have a lot
more adventures
in my life.

So maybe
this isn't
"The End"?

Exactly.
Maybe **YOUR**
next story is
starting
RIGHT NOW.

You got any
food that might
distract a Big
Bad Wolf-like
creature?

Little John,
let us buy some
of this deliciously
rich ice cream
and give to the
poor.

E
Fun

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"When I was a kid, my best friend
was Josh Funk. Now he's becoming a
friend to a whole new generation."

—B.J. Novak, author of the
#1 *New York Times* bestseller *The Book With No Pictures*



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